

The Bungalow 1934, Yavakapadi

10 COOL SUMMER ESCAPES

As summer comes knocking, plan your escape to these hill retreats with special places to stay

By Anurag Mallick & Priya Ganapathy

Yavakapadi, Coorg, Karnataka

Located along a picturesque ridge of the Brahmagiri range is the captivating hilly nook of Yavakapadi. Take a break in the hills, read a book by the brook or go on hikes to Baliyatra Ridge, Mallamma Betta and Thadiyandamol, the highest peak in Kodagu (Coorg). Stay at The Bungalow 1934, the erstwhile home of Diwan Bahadur Ketolira Chengappa, the first Chief Commissioner of Coorg. The hilltop bungalow within a coffee estate was run as a vintage homestay for a decade by his great grandson, rallyist Amrith Thimmaiah. After a recent renovation, the bungalow offers six spacious rooms, homemade chocolates by Amrith's mother Fancy and authentic Kodava cuisine that drew celebrity chef Gordon Ramsay to learn *pandi* (pork) curry here. This was where the Coorg leg of the India episode of *Uncharted Season 2* was filmed. The main bungalow has four rooms while the old garage, where Diwan Bahadur's 1955 Studebaker once stood, was redesigned into two rooms (Rs 12,000/couple, including breakfast and dinner; lunch on request; call Amrith at 9901315437 to book).

Getting there: Fly to Kannur airport and drive 83 km to The Bungalow 1934

Tungnath, Uttarakhand

At 3,680 m, Tungnath is the loftiest of the Panch Kedars and the highest Shiva temple in India. Located in the shadow of Chandrashila peak high above the treeline in Rudraprayag district, this was where, as the myth goes, the stars prayed to Lord Shiva and achieved their exalted position in the sky. Ravana *gufa* was where the king of Lanka supposedly performed a rigorous penance and severed his heads as an offering to Shiva, and at Chandrashila, Lord Vishnu received the celestial Sudarshan Chakra and Lord Rama came to atone for the sin of killing Ravana. Tungnath is a 4-km trek from Chopta and a further 1.5-km hike leads to Chandrashila. Stay at the luxurious Chopta Resort in Baniyakund (Rs 7,000; 9758667755, *www.choptaresort.com*).



Chopta Resort



Getting there: Fly to Dehradun and drive 216 km to Chopta in Rudraprayag district; Tungnath is a 4-km trek